

Patent landscaping: Patent landscaping is used for research groups, scientists and companies to plan and strategise. Patent landscaping maps out the relevant patents for a technology field. Prior to a design, patent landscaping can be used to identify areas for research, and possible creating new assets by applying for patents. Post the design process, patent landscaping can be used to identify possible infringement, and make the product reach the market as fast as possible.

Tipping point: The “Tipping Point” is an idea outlined by that name by Malcolm Gladwell. According to Gladwell, ideas change society by behaving like viruses. According to him, change is marked by an “epidemic” of new technologies. The concept is similar to Richard Dawkin’s “memes” that are ideas that spread from person to person, only more active.

Captive centre: Captive centres or units, are operations of a company wholly owned offshore. The operations are on foreign territory, but are controlled closely as a branch of the company, instead of just dumping the work on an outsourcing company.

Third-party units: Third party units are operations where the work, or parts of it is outsourced to a company on foreign soil. This is a common practice for reducing the cost to the company.

First contact: First contact resolution involves solving the problem the first time a customer calls in. The benefit is customer satisfaction, but the flipside is that the employees will be occupied for longer times on each call.

MBO: Management by objectives is a process where the administrators or the management of the company and the employees have a written or verbal agreement on all the objectives of the individual employees, as well as that of the company.

CDCP: Certified Data Centre Professionals is a certification by EPI, a British company. It is a course that standardises and guarantees a certain degree of proficiency to the certified individuals.

CMM: Capability Maturity Model was developed by the Carnegie Mellon Software Engineering Institute to assess the capability of software engineering companies to deliver on a contract. There are various “levels” of CMM certification, from 1 to 5. These levels stand for Initial, Repeatable, Institutionalised, Managed and Optimised. The levels describe the process within the organisation. Level 3 is considered prestigious.

CISA: Certified Information Systems Auditor are information system auditors, controllers and security professionals that are certified as meeting the requirements of Information Systems Audit and Control Association.

CISM: Certified Information Security Manager are information security overseers that are certified as meeting the requirements of Information Systems Audit and Control Association.

CISSP: Certified Information Systems Security Professional are Information Security managers that are certified by the International Information Systems Security Certification Consortium. There are about 60,000 certified individuals worldwide.